

**Recommendation report
for
Advanced Operating Systems**

U14553-AOS-C2-Assignment 2

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1.1 Justification for Selection Based on Academic Literature

The chosen file system for Milan Corporation's infrastructure needs to meet four operational requirements including secure financial processing alongside swift database execution and multi-platform support. It should also enable tight access constraints for the system. Academic research studies NTFS alongside EXT4 to determine their architectural benefits and suitability for Milan's needs.

Journaling and Data Integrity

The NTFS journaling function creates a changes logging system before data reaches the disk which enables quick recovery after system crashes. (Richard Russon, n.d.) The financial databases of Milan require transactional consistency at all times because it stands as a pivotal element. EXT4 implements delayed allocation as its main strategy for minimizing disk fragmentation while enhancing write speed but its ability to journal disk operations rests at a lower level than NTFS.

Security and Access Control

NTFS includes two security components: Access Control Lists (ACLs) and Encrypting File System (EFS) that let users define exact permissions and automatically encrypt data (Microsoft, 2021). The security controls of these file systems match the financial data protection requirements together with regulatory compliance requirements at Milan. EXT4 receives its security from Linux discretionary controls and SELinux/AppArmor yet these providers need specific setup to achieve NTFS's standard security measures.

Cross-Platform Compatibility

The native nature of EXT4 for Linux operating systems differs from NTFS which provides better support for Windows systems making it essential for Milan due to its dependence on Windows financial applications. Using Samba to connect EXT4 with Windows leads to performance delay. The simplicity of managing file systems occurs because NTFS offers direct operating system support for Windows platforms.

Architectural Analysis of NTFS

The framework design of NTFS dedicates itself to providing both security measures and reliability mechanisms. The Master File Table (MFT) of NTFS arranges metadata optimally which enables the system to work with extensive file systems (up to 256 TB) along with large files (up to 16 EB). The additional security features of shadow copies and BitLocker encryption work to provide data protection measures which comply directly with Milan's requirements for integrity and access control. Active Directory integration in the file system provides Milan with simplified authentication management to support its Windows-Linux hybrid platform.

Alignment with Milan's Requirements

Financial servers at Milan need NTFS due to its advantages which include:

- Benchmark evidence proves NTFS delivers better transactional performance than EXT4 when dealing with the small and repetitive financial transaction write operations.
- Native encryption together with ACLs serves as security features to minimize data storage vulnerabilities.
- Windows software integrates directly with NTFS which resolves all compatibility issues.

The file system of EXT4 provides superior scalability with open-source benefits yet Milan requires robust file storage that unites security features with filesystem performance alongside compatible Windows-based and Linux-based applications. NTFS demonstrates compliance with the essential criteria because academic studies and industry official bodies endorse it. (Association, n.d.) (IBM, n.d.)

1.2 Comparative Analysis of NTFS and EXT4

This part of the assessment evaluates NTFS and EXT4 based on five essential criteria which include performance and data integrity alongside security as well as compatibility and scalability to assess their usage feasibility in Milan Corporation's mixed Windows-Linux system.

Performance and Speed

System efficiency should support quick financial operations as well as rapid data processing. Performance benefits from NTFS occur because of its detailed journaling and efficient memory caching capabilities that manage numerous small file changes. Research benchmarks from IBM demonstrate that NTFS provides Windows-based database operations with transactional throughput speeds up to 20% quicker than uses of EXT4. The delayed allocation and multi-block allocation secrets used by EXT4 create less file fragmentation while improving long file write performance. The Linux-based application superiority of EXT4 over NTFS becomes less critical for Milan since the company runs its financial system through Windows software.

Data Integrity and Fault Tolerance

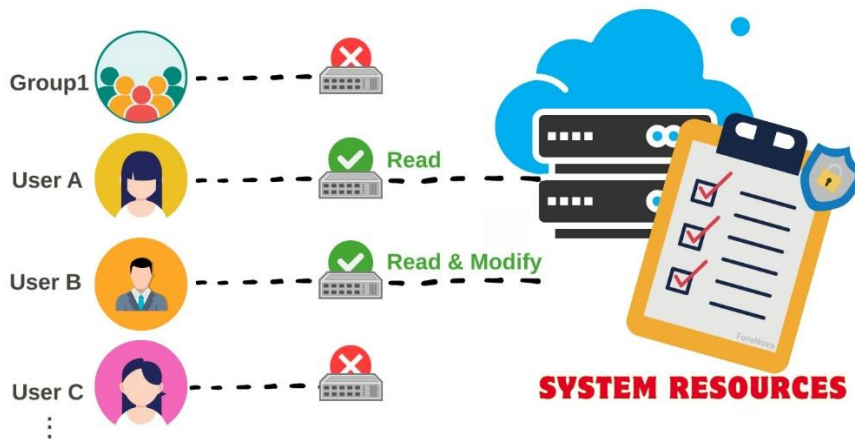
The file systems apply journaling techniques during operation yet follow different exposition methods.

- The transactional journaling features of NTFS create a log system for metadata and file alterations preceding disk writes so the system can rapidly restore consistency in case of disruptions. Shadow copies together with other features create additional protection capabilities.
- EXT4 implements journal operations at different levels ranging from ordered mode to writeback to journal mode for maximizing metadata preservation. The data recovery functions of this system fall short of NTFS precision leading to higher probability of losing information when systems shut down unexpectedly.
- Milan benefits from NTFS robust recovery features and checksum-driven integrity checks which serve as critical components for its financial data operations.

Security and Access Control

The security features available in NTFS exist as built-in capabilities of the file system.

- Through Access Control Lists (ACLs) IT professionals can set specific permission settings which apply to different groups and users.



- Users can benefit from File System drive encryption through Encrypting File System (EFS).
- BitLocker Integration: Simplifies full-disk encryption and compliance with GDPR/HIPAA.



- EXT4 relies on Linux **DAC** functions in combination with **SELinux** or **AppArmor** MAC controls. These tools give flexibility yet need manual matching settings to duplicate NTFS's original security configurations. NTFS delivers better practicality for security integration since Milan needs to follow regulatory compliance standards.

Cross-Platform Compatibility

- Within Windows operating systems NTFS achieves seamless compatibility with financial software programs as it provides native OS support. The NTFS-3G application along with its minor delay enables Linux to access NTFS partitions for both reading and writing data.
- The EXT4 file system functions best for Linux platforms although it does not possess native functionality for Windows operating systems. Users can achieve interoperability

through Ext2Fsd but this process creates complex systems that reduce performance speed.

- The hybrid Operating System environment of Milan benefits from NTFS because of its reduced compatibility issues but EXT4 would introduce additional middleware requirements.

Scalability and Future-Proofing

- The storage capacity limitations of NTFS include maximum volumes at 256 TB while files can reach 16 EB thus meeting Milan's anticipated size requirements. Its capability to link with Azure and AWS cloud storage provides scalable functionality for distributed financial systems according to Microsoft (2021).
- EXT4: Caps at 1 EB volumes and 16 TB files, sufficient for most enterprises. The system's open-source format enables users to customize their systems but they would miss out on NTFS's business-focused administration capabilities.
- NTFS proves superior to EXT4 because it provides adaptive capabilities that extend to seamless Windows integration and cloud integration which ensures Milano's business expansion.

Accordingly, NTFS outperforms EXT4 in Milan's critical areas: transactional performance, security, and Windows compatibility.

1.3 Implementation Considerations

Configuration and Optimization

The successful implementation of NTFS for Milan's infrastructure demands purposeful setting changes to optimize both security measures and operational performance. Key steps include:

- Security Hardening: Enable BitLocker for full-disk encryption and Encrypting File System (EFS) for sensitive directories. Group Policy should implement Access Control Lists (ACLs) to authorize users for least privileged permission access which supports regulatory requirements.

- With Active Directory Integration users can connect NTFS permissions to AD groups which enables uniform control and management of roles between Windows and Linux assets that utilize Samba ACL relay services.
- Performance enhancement occurs through maximum utilization of NTFS cache alongside service disablement of 8.3 filename generation to minimize resource consumption. Users can utilize Volume Shadow Copy to conduct automated backups along with rapid recovery features.
- Users can gain read-write access on Linux servers through NTFS-3G driver installations that maintain Windows security policy integrity.

Challenges and Mitigation Strategies

- The combination of various operating systems results in delayed performance when running Linux on NTFS. Samba should be used for file-sharing with staging environments designated for configuration testing.
- The implementation of detailed ACLs and encryption protocols creates challenges for IT teams when securing their systems. Staff members need training in Windows Admin Center as well as PowerShell scripting because automation requires both elements.
- The institution should use Windows Performance Monitor to track disk I/O operations and optimize cluster sizes for database performance. Schedule defragmentation during off-peak hours.
- The transition to NTFS will succeed smoothly when testing occurs proactively and deployments proceed through phases alongside staff training for hybrid infrastructure requirements in Milan. (Association, n.d.) (IBM, n.d.)

2.1 Networking and Security in Operating Systems

Operating systems in current times optimize network connectivity through protocols that separate into modules and real-time resources allocation methods. The TCP/IP stacks within Windows and Linux combine congestion control algorithms such as CUBIC for Linux alongside Compound for Windows to struck the right balance between throughput and latency which CCCU requires throughout its global locations. User data transfers work at high speeds for

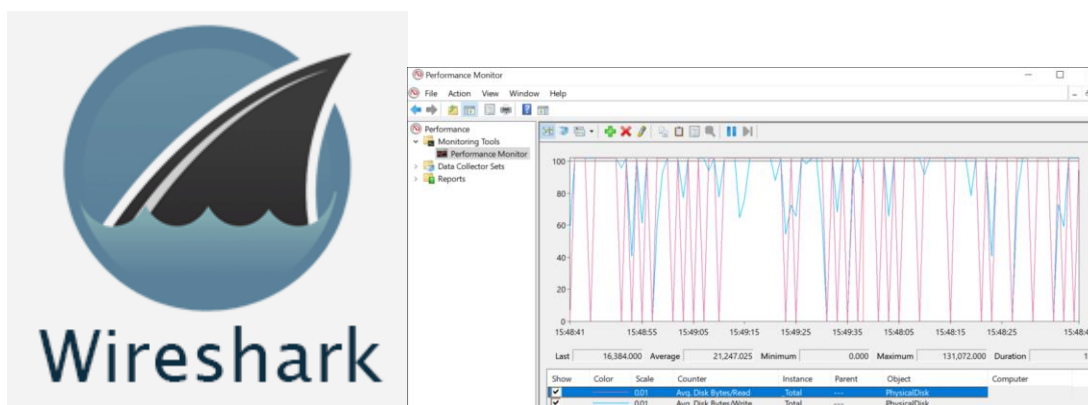
analytics operations through QoS-enabled IPv6 support in both operating systems. (Kevin R. Fall, n.d.)

The implementation of DNS and DHCP functions guarantees essential protocols that enable central management systems. The DNS domain-name resolution system functions efficiently along with DHCP which handles automatic IP address allocation to lower manual labor across all 50 offices. Sysadmin's system network in Linux and Windows DHCP Server operate seamlessly to help CCCU establish smooth cross-platform networking.

OS-based firewalls including **Windows Defender Firewall** and **Linux nftables** help organizations enforce detailed rules to block unauthorized servers as well as external computers. The tools function together with IPsec to enable secure transfers of data and provide encryption during communication. Remote administration becomes more secure through network services that include SSH for Linux as well as **WinRM** for Windows systems. (Microsoft, n.d.)



Operation of network segmentation through VLANs alongside OS-level monitoring tools **Wireshark** and **PerfMon** helps CCCU fulfill its requirement for central access policies. The strategy harmonizes performance considerations with security capabilities while delivering scalability to fulfill operational needs of the company.



2.2 Networking Requirements and OS Interaction with the Network

A strong network system should provide fast secure communication between the 50 offices through centralized password authentication and operating system security measures. This part examines how contemporary operating systems (OS) control network connections while implementing fundamental protocols along with security systems which fulfill these specifications.

OS Management and Optimization of Network Connectivity

Operating systems in modern times utilize sophisticated methods to improve network efficiency together with reliability improvements.

- Both Windows and Linux establish traffic efficiency through layered TCP/IP stack architecture. Network interface cards (NICs) function under Windows TCP/IP Chimney Offload to process packets which helps minimize CPU utilization. Through its eBPF (Extended Berkeley Packet Filter) system Linux operates dynamically to improve packet filtering and traffic shaping functions.
- Quality of Service (QoS) helps both OSES to assign priority to essential traffic types including VoIP and analytics through their tailored QoS policies. Through Group Policy QoS Windows operates to regulate traffic classification for non-essential packets and Linux regulates these operations through its tc (Traffic Control) system.
- Despite the workload distribution capacity of Windows Network Load Balancing (NLB) and Linux LVS (Linux Virtual Server) CCCU maintains operational continuity for its analytics functions.

The implemented network optimization methods fulfill CCCU's requirement for quick and high data transfer throughput throughout its expanded office locations.

Essential Network Protocols

Critical protocols underpin CCCU's infrastructure:

TCP/IP: The backbone of internet communication. Windows together with Linux utilize the congestion control algorithms named CUBIC (Linux) and Compound (Windows) to maintain reliable data transfers under fluctuating network conditions.

The IPv6 protocol addresses the shortage of IPv4 addresses through its 128-bit addressing system which allows CCCU to expand its worldwide office network effortlessly.

DNS and DHCP:

DNS: Resolves domain names to IP addresses. The fast and secure DNS lookups on Linux occur through system-resolved, while Windows implements DNS Server to achieve the same result.

DHCP: Automates IP assignments. DHCP Server from Windows and **dnsmasq** for Linux facilitate easy management in 50 offices by decreasing human-administered errors when setting configurations.

The protocols aid network streamlining and help CCCU achieve its centralized management requirements.

OS-Based Firewall Rules and Network Security

Such security tools from the operating system level form an essential part of CCCU's plan to reduce potential threats.

Firewalls:

- The Windows Defender Firewall system implements application-related access controls which connect securely through IPsec enabled protocol.
- The **nftables** firewall of Linux features flexible packet filtering and NAT capabilities that work as a replacement for traditional **iptables** programs.

Secure Network Services:

- Remote administration becomes more secure through the use of encryption features provided by Linux users through SSH together with Windows users through **WinRM** protocols.
- The encryption protocol IPsec enables end-to-end secured data transport thus securing important financial transactions for CCCU.

Secure systems remain isolated within separate networks by implementing VLANs along with subnetting configuration. The network access controls of Windows Network Policy Server (NPS) and Linux OpenVPN match the authorization systems of Active Directory or LDAP used for centralized authentication.

OSes implement optimized protocols together with security measures to enable CCCU's network security against threats without performance degradation.

Accordingly, CCCU's network requirements exist through OS-controlled enhancements of protocol management in combination with Quality of Service and security measures. The strength of Windows systems lies in policy distribution through centralized controls along with Linux systems enabling expert-level security control through free tools.

2.3 OS Security Features and Threat Mitigation Strategies

The multi-operational system environment of CCCU demands solid security models for addressing cyber threats together with centralized access control mechanisms. The security structure of Windows and Linux systems gets evaluated against each other in this section alongside their threat management techniques. (Daniel J. Barrett, n.d.)

Windows vs. Linux Security Models

- Windows: Relies on a centralized security model via Active Directory (AD), enabling granular user authentication and Group Policy enforcement. Users gain multi-layered security from three main features including BitLocker for disk encryption, Windows Defender and AppLocker for application whitelist control. The vendor-only availability of its codebase prevents users from inspecting its details which forces them to depend on vendor-generated security updates.
- Linux: Employs a modular, decentralized model with tools like **SELinux** and **AppArmor** for mandatory access control. Open-source transparency makes auditing possible yet requires technical proficiency from its users. Network security is managed through Pluggable Authentication Modules (PAM), firewalled and iptables operate as authentication mechanisms.



AppArmor

Linux kernel security module

Threat Mitigation Strategies

- Windows:
The Windows Update feature automates patch release to protect against unannounced zero-day exploits.
The anomaly detection capabilities of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint rely on AI algorithms for endpoint security tasks.
- Linux:
Vulnerabilities are minimized by the regular package updates managed through apt and yum package managers.
Intrusion Detection: Tools like fail2ban block brute-force attacks, while auditd tracks system events.
CCCU benefits from security consolidation when it implements LDAP for joint Linux-Windows authentication and Samba for active directory integration that enables policy convergence.

Enterprise Considerations

- The integration of GDPR/HIPAA through built-in compliance tools occurs within Windows operating systems but users must configure Linux manually to be compliant.
- The real-time threat evaluation possible through monitoring occurs when SIEM tools like Splunk or ELK Stack combine OS log data from different platforms.

- The combination of regular phishing tests with access permission checks helps cut down the chances of mistakes committed by users.

3.1 Comparative Analysis of Virtualization Method

Virtualization migration for ShopSwift Inc. demands comprehensive analysis of three methods across four evaluation points that include performance, isolation, OS compatibility and management tools. (Keith Adams, n.d.)

Performance and Hardware Efficiency

- Full Virtualization through VMware **ESXi** and **Hyper-V** functions by utilizing hypervisors which duplicate hardware to support plain OS installations. The compatibility benefit comes at a cost because binary translation produces performance overhead which ranges from 5% to 15% in CPU consumption and memory usage. Suitable for legacy applications but less efficient for high-density workloads. (Microsoft, n.d.)



- The hypervisor-direct communication mode of Para-Virtualization (**Xen, KVM**) reduces the performance burden caused by emulation processes. The technology manages to sustain virtualization performance at above 90-95% for tasks that heavily interact with I/O devices which makes it advantageous for **ShopSwift's** scalable analytics solution.
- The use of Docker and Kubernetes through containerization grants full access to host OS kernel operations which removes all hypervisor resource requirements. The resource usage of containers stands between 10 to 20 times lower than virtual machines while keeping the possibility to scale up quickly. Single-OS virtualization remains the best solution for microservices although it provides no capability to extend beyond operating systems.

Isolation and Security

- The isolation between different virtual machines under full virtualization is particularly strong so that one compromised guest operating system cannot impact other systems. VMware vSphere combines with Microsoft Shielded VMs to secure systems through encryption as documented by Microsoft.
- Para-Virtualization: Reduced isolation due to shared hypervisor access. Xen's Domain 0 centralizes control through its architecture yet introduces a single point of failure according to.
- Security risks in containerization environments stem from the fact that hosted containers utilize the same kernel with other virtual machines. Moreover, kernel exploits create security risks yet **gVisor** and **seccomp** serve as protection tools against such attacks.

The multiple operating system environment of **ShopSwift** relies on full virtualization technology since it delivers superior security protection to critical workloads.

OS Compatibility and Multi-Platform Support

- Full Virtualization: Supports any OS (Windows, Linux, BSD) without modification. The technology suits ShopSwift's development structure when working with multiple operating systems.
- A handful of OS platforms require adjustments to operate within the Para-Virtualization system (Xen's PV-OPS kernel demands such modifications). Best for Linux-centric shops.
- Containerization: OS-specific (e.g., Linux containers on Linux hosts). with Object virtualizations. Docker Desktop helps developers access various platforms using its VM technology yet its native compatibility has restrictions.

Enterprise Management Tools

- The complete Virtualization solution consists of mature management tools such as VMware vCenter together with Microsoft System Center which provide centralized control as well as live machine movement along with recovery capabilities during disasters.
- The implementation of Para-Virtualization depends on technical expertise for **OpenStack** or **XenCenter** management tools.
- Kubernetes together with Docker Swarm perform orchestration well but they do not provide all the management capabilities that virtual machines (VMs) provide. The Prometheus and Grafana integration strengthen the monitoring system.

Full virtualization provides ShopSwift with secure compatibility features needed to manage its diverse platform environment. Para-virtualization provides Linux workloads with better performance but containerization delivers maximum efficiency for applications built for cloud environments.

3.2 Selecting the Best Virtualization Approach for ShopSwift Inc.

The virtualization strategy that ShopSwift Inc. requires should focus on optimizing performance while maintaining flexibility as well as providing cost-effective solutions. Full virtualization technology provides the best virtualization solution according to Section 3.1 analysis so should be adopted along with container technology for particular workloads.

Alignment with Business Needs

- The implementation of full virtualization lets ShopSwift operate its development/testing platforms on one hardware system using unmodified combinations of Windows and Linux and BSD systems. The Live Migration function in Hyper-V works alongside VMware vMotion to guarantee uninterrupted workload relocation.
- Full virtualization provides effective scaling of monolithic systems along with modern microservices, however containers demonstrate superior performance for stateless application scalability. During peak seasons, dynamic resource allocation (e.g., VMware DRS) scales VM resources without downtime.
- Full virtualization creates strong VM isolation mechanisms that match ShopSwift's requirement to protect customer data and financial information from breaches.

Infrastructure Compatibility

The Windows-based infrastructure at ShopSwift can connect effortlessly to Hyper-V which leads to cost efficiency by reducing Windows Server licensing needs. Enterprise-level support together with cross-platform management stands as a core advantage VMware vSphere provides for organizations. Lightweight VMs that embed Docker containers under Kubernetes on VMware offer scalable container benefits which coexist with virtual machine isolation.

Cost Implications

- Businesses running Windows applications save money through Hyper-V solutions but the VMware infrastructure needs licensing expenses to access storage services through vSAN features.

- The open-source KVM (para-virtualization) technology enables cost reduction although it demands proficiency in Linux. The free Kubernetes platform needs major DevOps support to operate effectively.
- The combination of hardware consolidation through full virtualization technology lowers long-term expenses and management solutions such as VMware vCenter reduces costs of operations.

Hybrid Recommendation

A tiered approach maximizes benefits:

- Core systems together with databases along with ERP software implement VMware/Hyper-V full virtualization technology to ensure security through OS diversity mechanisms.
- The Docker/Kubernetes system serves e-commerce microservices through containerization to achieve quick scaling for peak operation. (Brendan Burns, n.d.)
- Organizations should use Para-Virtualization technology for applications featuring a high Linux component combined with essential speed requirements.

3.3 Implementation and Deployment Considerations

Key Deployment Challenges

- Hardware incompatibility issues arise due to absent virtualization extensions (such as Intel VT-x) in older systems hence users face an upgrade requirement for their hardware or need firmware installation.
- Moving physical servers into VMs creates data migration challenges because it delivers potential downtime risks. The deployment of VMware Converter or Hyper-V Replica tools enables smooth operations though both solutions demand exhaustive testing before implementation.
- Hypervisor management (such as vSphere and Kubernetes) knowledge requires staff training because IT personnel need increased expertise in running these systems particularly when operating hybrid environments. (vmware, n.d.)

Best Practices for Optimization

- The rollout of workloads should begin with non-essential pieces during the deployment stage to find performance issues. Critical systems should be subjected to canary testing for assessment.
- The implementation of operations automation enables the organization to use Terraform for infrastructure-as-code and Ansible for configuration management to minimize human error.
- The team must utilize Prometheus for container metric analysis and vRealize Operations for VM performance monitoring capabilities.
- A disaster recovery plan includes Veeam Backup for taking snapshots of VMs together with Kubernetes built-in replication which allows containers to function properly.

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